

SRNN Model Parameter Table

This document describes the equations, state variables, derived quantities, and parameters used by the `run_all_analyses.m` pipeline (sensitivity, tau sensitivity, parameter-space, and DC Lyapunov analyses). It uses a **single STD timescale** and the **logistic activation function**, matching the current `SRNNModel2` defaults and the master overrides set in `run_all_analyses.m` (`c_E = 0.5/3`).

System Equations

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dx_i}{dt} &= \frac{-x_i + u_i + \sum_{j=1}^N w_{ij} b_j r_j}{\tau_d} \\ r_i &= \phi \left(x_i - c \sum_{k=1}^K a_{ik} \right) \\ \frac{da_{ik}}{dt} &= \frac{-a_{ik} + r_i}{\tau_{a_k}} \\ \frac{db_i}{dt} &= \frac{1 - b_i}{\tau_{rec}} - \frac{b_i r_i}{\tau_{rel}} \end{aligned}$$

Abbreviations: - **SRNN**: Stable Recurrent Nonlinear Network - **SFA**: Spike frequency adaptation - **STD**: Short-term synaptic depression

Table 1: Model Parameters

Symbol	Name	Value	Description
State Variables			
x_i	Membrane potential	$(-\infty, \infty)$	Dendritic potential of neuron i
a_{ik}	Adaptation variable	$[0, 1]$	SFA state for neuron i , timescale k
b_i	Synaptic resource	$[0, 1]$	STD variable for neuron i (available resources)
Dependent Variables			
r_i	Firing rate	$(0, 1)$	Instantaneous firing rate, $r_i = \phi(\cdot)$
$b_i r_i$	Synaptic output	$(0, 1)$	Effective synaptic output after STD
u_i	External input	arbitrary	External drive to neuron i
Connection Weight parameters			
w_{ij}	Connection weights	—	$N \times N$ sparse weight matrix
N	Network size	300	Total number of neurons
f	Fraction excitatory	$\frac{1}{2}$	Fraction of excitatory neurons, remainder are inhibitory
S	Sparsity mask	—	Binary mask, $S_{ij} \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\alpha)$
α	Connection probability	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\alpha = \text{indegree}/N = 100/300$
F	Default scaling factor	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{N\alpha(2-\alpha)}}$	Scaling factor which yields $R = 1$ if $\tilde{\mu}_E, \tilde{\mu}_I, \tilde{\sigma}_E$, and $\tilde{\sigma}_I$ are equal (see derivation below).
$\tilde{\mu}_E$	Mean excitatory weight	$3F$	Normalized mean of non-zero E weights
$\tilde{\mu}_I$	Mean inhibitory weight	$-4F$	Normalized mean of non-zero I weights. Since $f = \frac{1}{2}$, inhibition exceeds excitation ($-4F$ vs. $+3F$), creating a negative global outlier eigenvalue
$\tilde{\sigma}_E$	Std dev excitatory	F	Normalized std dev of non-zero E weights
$\tilde{\sigma}_I$	Std dev inhibitory	F	Normalized std dev of non-zero I weights
g	Level of chaos	swept	Multiplicative scaling on w_{ij} (<code>level_of_chaos</code> , e.g. swept over $[0.5, 3]$); the reported spectral radius is $R = g$ at the default normalization
Time Constants (s)			
τ_d	Dendritic time constant	0.1	Membrane integration time constant
τ_{a_k}	SFA time constants	$\{0.25, 1.58, 10\}$	Logspaced from 0.25 to 10, $K = 3$ timescales
τ_{rec}	STD recovery	$\frac{1}{4}$	Synaptic vesicle recovery time constant
τ_{rel}	STD release	$\frac{1}{4}$	Synaptic vesicle release time constant
Adaptation Strength			
c_E	SFA coupling	$\frac{1}{6}$	SFA strength per timescale for E neurons (<code>master_c_E</code> in <code>run_all_analyses.m</code>)
Activation Function			
ϕ	Logistic sigmoid	$\phi(x) = \frac{1}{1 + \exp(-4(x - S_c))}$	Logistic function with unit slope at the center, range $(0, 1)$
S_c	Sigmoid center	0.35	Horizontal center; $\phi(S_c) = \frac{1}{2}$ and slope $\phi'(S_c) = 1$

Definition of the Activation Function $\phi(x)$

The activation function is a **logistic sigmoid** with unit slope at its center, centered at S_c :

$$\phi(x) = \frac{1}{1 + \exp(-4(x - S_c))}$$

Domain: $(-\infty, \infty)$
Range: $(0, 1)$

Derivative:

$$\phi'(x) = 4 \phi(x) (1 - \phi(x))$$

Parameter interpretation:

- S_c : The horizontal center of the sigmoid. At $x = S_c$, the function outputs $\phi(S_c) = \frac{1}{2}$ and has unit slope ($\phi'(S_c) = 1$; the factor 4 in the exponent sets that slope). A positive S_c shifts the inflection to positive x , so at the resting operating point (small x) the network sits on the lower, low-gain part of the curve.
Note: The logistic sigmoid is smooth (C^∞), so its derivative is available in closed form for the Jacobian used by the QR Lyapunov method.

Derivation of the Default Scaling Factor F

The scaling factor F is derived from Harris (2023), Equations 16 and 18.

Equation 16 — Sparse variance for population $k \in \{e, i\}$:

$$\sigma_{sk}^2 = \alpha(1 - \alpha)\tilde{\mu}_k^2 + \alpha\tilde{\sigma}_k^2$$

Equation 18 — Spectral radius:

$$\mathcal{R} = \sqrt{N[f\sigma_{se}^2 + (1 - f)\sigma_{si}^2]}$$

Derivation: To find the scaling factor F that yields a unit spectral radius ($\mathcal{R} = 1$) when all normalized parameters are equal, set $|\tilde{\mu}_E| = |\tilde{\mu}_I| = \tilde{\sigma}_E = \tilde{\sigma}_I = F$.

Substituting into Eq. 16:

$$\sigma_{se}^2 = \sigma_{si}^2 = \alpha(1 - \alpha)F^2 + \alpha F^2 = F^2[\alpha - \alpha^2 + \alpha] = F^2 \cdot \alpha(2 - \alpha)$$

Substituting into Eq. 18, noting that $f + (1 - f) = 1$:

$$\mathcal{R} = \sqrt{N \cdot F^2 \cdot \alpha(2 - \alpha)} = 1$$

Solving for F :

$$F = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N\alpha(2 - \alpha)}}$$

Note on Zero Row Sum (ZRS): Harris (2023) describes a Zero Row Sum condition (ZRS/SZRS) that controls “local” eigenvalue outliers escaping the spectral disc. In these simulations, we deliberately did not apply the ZRS condition in order to test whether adaptation mechanisms (SFA and STD) could fulfill a similar stabilizing role—effectively examining if adaptation can substitute for ZRS in constraining network dynamics.

Table 2: Adaptation Conditions

The four conditions are defined by enabling/disabling SFA and STD via the number of timescales ($K = n_{a_E}$ for SFA, n_{b_E} for STD):

Condition	n_{a_E} (K)	n_{a_I}	n_{b_E}	n_{b_I}	Description
No Adaptation	0	0	0	0	Baseline
SFA Only	3	0	0	0	Spike-frequency adaptation enabled
STD Only	0	0	1	0	Short-term depression enabled
SFA + STD	3	0	1	0	Both mechanisms enabled

Effect on parameters:

- When $n_{a_E} = 0$: No SFA variables a_{ik} ; the $c_E \sum_k a_{ik}$ term is zero.
- When $n_{a_E} = 3$: Three SFA timescales with $\tau_{a_k} \in \{0.25, 1.58, 10\}$ s (logspaced) and coupling $c_E = \frac{0.5}{3}$.
- When $n_{b_E} = 0$: No STD variable b_i ; synaptic output equals r_i (equivalent to $b_i = 1$).
- When $n_{b_E} = 1$: STD enabled with a single timescale, recovery constant $\tau_{rec} = 1$ s and release constant $\tau_{rel} = \frac{1}{4}$ s; the resource enters the recurrent term as the product $b_i r_i$.

Inhibitory neurons have no adaptation mechanisms ($n_{a_I} = n_{b_I} = 0$).

Implementation note: When any of n_{a_E} , n_{a_I} , n_{b_E} , or n_{b_I} is set to zero, the corresponding state variables (a_{ik} or b_i) are excluded from the system state vector and the Jacobian matrix. This prevents spurious zero eigenvalues that would otherwise arise from including disabled adaptation dynamics.